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Summary

The essay emphasises the necessity of good leadership in healthcare, specifically in enhancing care quality and operational efficiency. It explores several leadership theories and styles, such as Trait Theory and Behavioural Theory, and their applications in healthcare contexts. The investigation also looks at Elisabeth House, an acute patient mental health hospital that needs to improve its safety, efficiency, and leadership, according to a Care Quality Commission (CQC) audit.

Furthermore, the article emphasises the importance of organisational healthcare culture, highlighting the necessity for a patient-centred approach and a healthy workplace culture. It also discusses the necessity of leadership models and frameworks, recommending the use of the NHS Leadership for Change model and the Hackman model to successfully address Elisabeth House's improvement requirements.

Furthermore, the essay points out the significance of training and development in healthcare organisations, especially in addressing staff training gaps and improving familiarity with electronic systems. It also emphasises the significance of patient engagement in care planning and risk management to provide complete and personalised care.

In conclusion, the article makes recommendations for Elisabeth House, such as establishing leadership models, improving staff training, increasing patient engagement in care planning, and strengthening risk management protocols. These initiatives attempt to increase operational effectiveness and, ultimately, the quality of care delivered to Elisabeth House's patients.

Introduction

Effective leadership among healthcare professionals is crucial for improving the quality of care and efficiency (Sfantou et al., 2017). Leadership has been defined as the interaction between the individual/s who leads and those who choose to follow, and it refers to the behaviour of leading and organising the actions of a group or team of individuals towards a shared goal (Sfantou et al., 2017). Management and leadership are viewed as equally crucial in achieving organisation objectives. However, the two jobs have different functions. Management creates order and stability, but leadership promotes change and movement (Diggele et al., 2020). Additionally, there are a variety of theories in leadership, for example, trait leadership and behavioural leadership.

The Trait Theory, one of the first methods to understanding leadership, contends that certain underlying qualities and attributes make people natural leaders (Alvarez, 2023). Supporters of this idea believe that people are born with certain characteristics such as charisma, intellectual ability, assurance, and emotional intelligence that drive them towards successful leadership (Alvarez, 2023). Unlike the Trait Theory, the Behavioural Theory focuses on leaders' actions and behaviours instead of their natural characteristics (Alvarez, 2023).

Throughout this assignment, a healthcare organisation will be examined and ideas for improving the quality of treatment will be proposed. The Care Quality Commission UK (CQC) has assessed this organisation as "requires improvement". Elizabeth House is an acute inpatient mental health facility that provides assessment and treatment to adult men and women undergoing an acute episode of mental illness. According to the CQC assessment, this health institution needs to enhance its safety, provide services more efficiently, respond to people's needs, and have an effective leadership team.

Another important aspect to consider when assessing an organization's performance/distribution of care is its organizational healthcare culture. Any organisational culture should have people as its primary priority, and the healthcare industry is no exception. This is important because it involves establishing clear requirements for reciprocal respect, compassion, empathy, honesty, and trust for each individual and interaction, including co-workers and patients. (Thomas, 2024). The advantage of having a strong and distinct organisational culture is that it allows big groups of individuals to collaborate, sometimes from

different backgrounds and perspectives. According to Thomas (2024), an organisation with a beneficial and functioning culture is more likely to hold onto its personnel and patients and achieve its goals.

The goal of this assignment is to investigate the function and significance of traditional and contemporary leadership theories and concepts in the health and care context. It will also examine the benefits of adopting theoretical models for developing an effective leadership team in a health and care environment. This assignment will discuss the function of leaders, the importance of leadership styles, and the ideal leadership personality characteristics in driving change in health and care settings. Finally, this assignment will include proposals on managing teams throughout transitional phases in a health and care context to maximise organisational performance.

Description of the health/care organisation undergoing change

Elisabeth House is a care facility undergoing its first inspection by the Care Quality Commission (CQC). While some areas require improvement, the facility maintains safe and clean ward environments and ensures adequate staffing levels to minimize restrictive practices and manage medicines safely. Despite challenges, managers prioritize staff training, supervision, and appraisals, fostering a collaborative multidisciplinary team approach. Patients receive compassionate care, and the facility effectively manages beds to ensure timely admissions and discharges.

To better understand leadership, consider the many leadership styles that might be applied in healthcare settings. Three styles will be discussed. Leadership styles include transactional, transformational, and charismatic. The transactional model is a transaction-based authoritative relationship in which exchanges/ transactions occur between a leader and a follower once certain goals have been determined or settled upon (Diggele et al., 2020). Transformational leadership is defined as leadership via the transformation of individuals to achieve a common organisational purpose (Diggele et al., 2020). This modern kind of leadership focuses on motivating individuals and developing teams to achieve goals (Diggele et al., 2020). According to transformational leadership theory, people are driven by the responsibilities they must fulfil. Those who adopt transformational leadership prioritise collaboration and group effort, and people thrive within an organisation or community as a

whole rather than in competition with one another (Olley, 2023). This is a vital consideration when referring to a healthcare organisation since it requires all possible assistance, not only from carers and doctors but also from patients and their families. The primary motivation behind this is the need to improve the quality of health services in the context of expanding healthcare demands and the requirement for improved efficiency and productivity. Engaging professionals in a vision and empowering them to lead the change process is more likely to be effective than alternative approaches (Kumar and Khiljee, 2015).

Leadership theories and styles are significant because they underscore the character traits and actions individuals can adopt to enhance their leadership capabilities (Simplilearn, 2024). Leaders often highlight certain qualities as essential for effective leadership, such as strong moral principles and ethics, excellent organizational abilities, being a competent learner, fostering employee development, and cultivating affiliation and connection among team members (Simplilearn, 2024).

Furthermore, Leadership Models and frameworks offer valuable resources for comprehending and guiding the complex improvement paths (Lakas et al., 2019). In this case, Elisabeth House requires developing a comprehensive approach to address the identified areas needing improvement and drive sustainable change throughout the organisation. Two different leadership models will help this organisation address the identified areas needing improvement and ultimately enhance the quality of care provided to patients.

In relevance to Elisabeth House, the first model that best suits their case is the NHS Leadership for Change model. This model offers valuable resources for comprehending and guiding the complex paths of improvement (NHS Improving Quality, 2013). However, the presence of various leadership development models poses challenges for professionals aiming to create interventions tailored to the specific developmental requirements of leaders and the organizations they support (NHS Improving Quality, 2013). Given Elisabeth House's need for improvement and change in response to the CQC report, this model will provide a systematic framework for planning, implementing, and managing change initiatives effectively.

Additionally, the Hackman model at Elisabeth House could greatly improve care quality and efficiency. It ensures each staff member has clear roles, fostering accountability and teamwork (Jay, 2023). Setting clear goals aligns efforts and motivates staff. Optimizing workflows and resources supports efficient care delivery (Jay, 2023). Providing tools, resources, and training empowers staff. Offering coaching and mentoring enhances staff performance (Jay, 2023). Overall, the application of the Hackman model at Elisabeth House

can help create a positive work environment, improve staff morale and engagement, enhance operational efficiency, and ultimately, improve the quality of care provided to patients.

A report on Concepts

Given that healthcare organisations are directly involved in people's lives, handling critical tasks such as managing medical equipment, administering medication, and providing treatment and care, it becomes paramount to carefully select and recruit qualified individuals for these roles (Agrol et al., 2022). The HR department plays a crucial role in ensuring that these responsibilities are met effectively. With the HR department overseeing the recruitment of both clinical and non-clinical staff, it is essential to prioritize comprehensive training provided by experts to ensure that employees are fully equipped to fulfil their duties competently (Agrol et al., 2022). The selection process involves choosing the most suitable candidate for a job vacancy, ensuring they possess the necessary skills and attitude to fulfil their role effectively (Agrol et al., 2022).

According to the CQC report, staff at Elisabeth House demonstrate awareness of the main risks to each patient and take proactive measures to prevent or mitigate these risks. Nurses conduct risk assessments, although some support workers may not have seen individual patient assessments and rely on verbal handovers for risk information. Staff are responsive to changes in patient risks and effectively manage incidents when they occur. However, there are inconsistencies in minimizing risks when patients cannot be easily observed, as some areas remain unsupervised despite identified risks. Overall, staff adhere to policies and procedures for ensuring patient safety, including conducting searches when necessary.

Every organization requires a well-defined vision, mission, goals, objectives, and long-term strategies to transform their business into a dynamic force (Sonkiya, 2023). These statements serve to chart the organization's future direction and create a vivid mental picture of its aspirations and purpose (Sonkiya, 2023). Elisabeth House’s mission is to deliver top-notch, comprehensive, MDT-centred care aimed at assessing, treating, and planning the discharge of patients to continue their treatment and care within their local communities as

required (Elisabeth House, no date). Furthermore, organisational culture can impact the delivery of care in organisations like Elisabeth House. People should be at the centre of every organisational culture, especially in health care. This entails setting explicit expectations of reciprocal respect, compassion, empathy, honesty, and trust for all individuals and interactions, including co-workers and patients (Thomas, 2024). A patient-centred culture in healthcare institutions leads to improved patient satisfaction and outcomes by focusing on individual wellness goals (Thomas, 2024). A positive workplace culture fosters employee growth, reduces turnover, and encourages staff to stay with the organization by providing valued, understood, and autonomous roles (Thomas, 2024). This, in turn, enhances operational efficiency, contributing to stable long-term operations through employee retention, patient satisfaction, and clear organizational workflows. After reading the CQC report, all patients agreed that the staff was polite and kind and treated them well. All patients said they had privacy and staff always knocked on their bedroom doors before entering. This shows reciprocal respect, compassion, and empathy towards the patients at the healthcare facility.

In addition to this analysis, a SWOT analysis will help with further understanding and possible improvement of Elisabeth House's organisation performance. SWOT is a term that stands for Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats. A SWOT analysis is a method used by organizations to measure and evaluate their overall performance (Blasbalg, 2023). SWOT analysis assists organizations in a variety of areas, including internal operations, marketing and sales, financial management, staffing and human resources, customer service, and quality assurance. A SWOT analysis simplifies difficult situations by reducing large amounts of data into manageable points, facilitating decision-making processes (Kenton, 2023). Following this, a SWOT analysis table will be utilized to assess specific aspects of Elisabeth House, aiming to enhance its operational effectiveness and performance.

SWOT analysis on Elisabeth House

Strengths	Weaknesses
Specialized Mental Health Care: Elisabeth House provides specialised inpatient mental health treatment to adults, both male and female, who are suffering from acute bouts of mental illness. This specialised emphasis enables individualised therapy and care. Patient Satisfaction: Patients have shown high levels of satisfaction with the care offered, including good remarks on staff respect, friendliness, and effective management of violent episodes. Comprehensive Activities: The hospital offers a range of therapeutic activities, such as smoothie making, music sessions, quizzes, board games, and walks, which contribute to a comprehensive approach to patient treatment. Well-Managed Safety: Patients report feeling safe at the facility, with personnel respecting privacy by knocking on bedroom doors before entering and properly addressing violent occurrences.	Lack of Training Awareness: Staff training records show errors, with concerns highlighted regarding organizational staff's access to obligatory training and clinical staff's familiarity with electronic patient record systems. Inconsistent Care Planning: Not all patients participate in their care planning, and care plans may lack individuality and fail to effectively reflect patient opinions and engagement. Risk Management Improvements: The hospital should increase ligature risk assessment awareness and adherence, assure patient risk assessment access, and improve capacity assessment and recording processes. Limited Visitor Facilities: There is a need for adequate rooms to receive visitors, especially for patients whose relatives travel long distances, and additional seating in courtyards to enhance patient comfort.
Opportunities	**Threats**
Enhanced Training and Development: Investing in staff training and development programs can solve training knowledge gaps and increase familiarity with electronic systems, resulting in more efficient and effective patient care. Conducting extensive examinations of risk management techniques, such as ligature risk assessments and risk registers, can help to reinforce safety protocols and verify compliance with national guidelines and best practices.	Challenges in Staff Retention: High employee turnover rates in the healthcare industry jeopardize organizational stability and continuity of service. Consequently, it is critical to address workplace culture and offer sufficient support and training to retain qualified personnel. Regulatory Compliance: The reputation and efficiency of the hospital may suffer if issues pointed out by oversight organizations like the Care Quality Commission (CQC) are not addressed.

Advice to the organisation's board

Elisabeth House serves an important role in delivering acute inpatient mental health services to adult men and women suffering from acute mental illness. Identifying and addressing any current difficulties is critical to the organization's sustained operational performance. The following advice report includes findings, analysis, and recommendations to improve the operational efficacy of Elisabeth House.

According to the CQC report for Elisabeth House, there are weaknesses in staff training records, particularly in terms of agency personnel access to obligatory training and clinical staff familiarity with electronic patient record systems. Following this, some possible solutions to these problems could be Implementing a thorough training program for all employees, including agency workers, to guarantee compliance with mandated training requirements and familiarity with electronic systems and providing continual training and assistance to help workers become more skilled and comfortable in using electronic patient records. As Bredfeldt et al. stated in their article (2013), health information technology (HIT) has the potential to enhance healthcare quality, boost patient safety, and lower costs. Achieving that potential requires healthcare providers to be both willing and capable of using the technology effectively. Despite the current high exposure to electronic health records (EHRs), many practitioners are sceptical that EHRs can improve patient care and clinical outcomes (Bredfeldt et al., 2013).

Another issue identified by CQC is that not all patients are involved in their care planning, and care plans may lack personalization and reflect patient views and involvement in an appropriate manner. Following this, one viable option is to develop a structured process for including patients in care planning, considering their preferences and goals. Nonetheless, teach staff on person-centred care planning strategies to improve personalization and patient involvement. Davidson and Tondora (2022) believe that person-centred care is recognizing and protecting an individual's right to self-direction while setting goals for care, proving that it will positively impact the delivery of care.

Furthermore, there are gaps in risk management methods, particularly in ligature risk assessment and patient risk management. Elisabeth House should conduct a complete evaluation of current risk management processes and procedures to identify and fix deficiencies. Additionally, they must guarantee that employees are sufficiently trained in risk assessment and management, with regular updates and refresher courses provided. Healthcare

risk management has typically been concerned with patient safety and eliminating medical errors to protect organizations' missions and financial liabilities (N Catalyst, 2018). However, due to technological improvements, cybersecurity concerns, and changing regulatory landscapes, risk management has become increasingly difficult (N Catalyst, 2018). The change to value-based care models, combined with greater financial risk for providers, needs a more comprehensive risk management approach (N Catalyst, 2018). Hospitals are shifting from reactive to proactive risk management techniques that include the entire healthcare ecosystem, emphasizing clinical quality to sustain financial performance and mitigate brand damage (N Catalyst, 2018).

Another difficulty is that proper visitor facilities and amenities are required, particularly for patients whose families must travel long distances. Some solutions to this problem involve evaluating existing visitor facilities and amenities to find areas for improvement, such as increased seats and flexible visiting hours. Furthermore, Elisabeth House could consider introducing initiatives to improve visitor's comfort and convenience, such as designated visitor lounges and expanded visiting hours. These adjustments will allow the family to have more touch with their patients and better support them. These solutions are important because the family of origin has a strong influence on patients from the time they are born, moulding their attachments, actions, and habits throughout their lives (Ong et al., 2021). Families provide refuge, support, and resources, and patients naturally turn to them in times of need (Ong et al., 2021). People with mental illnesses rely even more on their families, as mental health issues can be linked to a variety of social and psychological factors within the family.

Elisabeth House requires transformational leadership. As explained before, transformational leaders value collaboration and group effort, emphasizing the need of organizational or community unity. This strategy is essential in a hospital setting like Elisabeth House since it involves the participation of not just caregivers and medical experts, but also patients and their families. Transformational leaders focus on healthcare workers' well-being and engage them in a change vision, empowering them to take the lead in the transformation process. This approach is considered to be more effective than alternative leadership styles (Kumar and Khiljee, 2015).

Elisabeth House should implement the NHS Leadership for Change model as a systematic framework for addressing the CQC report's identified improvement needs. Furthermore, using the Hackman model may improve care quality and efficiency by clarifying roles, establishing clear goals, and empowering employees through training and coaching.

These strategies can boost employee morale, operational efficiency, as well as the quality of care offered to patients at Elisabeth House.

Conclusion

Effective leadership is essential in healthcare for both quality and efficiency. Elisabeth House, a mental health facility, is facing issues with staff training, care planning, risk management, and visitor amenities. Adopting leadership models such as NHS Leadership for Change and the Hackman model can help establish systematic frameworks for change. The Care Quality Commission found weaknesses that may be addressed by prioritising person-centred care planning, providing extensive staff training, and improving visiting amenities. Transformational leadership, which prioritises cooperation and empowerment, is critical for creating change. Elisabeth House may improve its operational effectiveness and patient care quality by employing strategic leadership models and addressing identified areas for improvement.

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